

## ▼ RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **MEDICAL DOCTOR** *see pp. 276–277*
- ▶ **OPTOMETRIST** *see pp. 294–295*
- ▶ **DENTAL HYGIENIST** Advises patients on how to look after their teeth and gums to help prevent tooth decay and gum disease. Dental hygienists use dental instruments to clean and polish patients' teeth and to remove dental plaque.
- ▶ **DENTAL TECHNICIAN** Designs and constructs a range of dental devices to repair decaying teeth, replace lost teeth, and to improve the general appearance of teeth. Although technicians work closely with dentists, they have limited contact with patients.

## SKILLS GUIDE



Excellent communication skills to interact with patients and explain treatments to them.



Strong leadership abilities for recruiting, training, and managing a dental practice team.



Good interpersonal skills to understand patients' problems and to put them at ease.



Excellent manual dexterity for carrying out intricate dental work using medical instruments.



Attention to detail and precision to ensure that treatments are administered accurately.



**ORTHODONTIST** Corrects the abnormal alignment of the teeth and jaws by fitting dental appliances, such as dental braces and space retainers.



**MAXILLOFACIAL SURGEON** Offers reconstructive surgery to patients who have defects or injuries—such as cleft palates, accident injury, or cancers—to the mouth, teeth, jaws, and face.



**HOSPITAL DENTIST** Treats patients in a hospital setting, carrying out complex dental and surgical procedures. Hospital dentists may specialize in restorative surgery, or in pediatric dentistry—treating children—for example.



**PUBLIC HEALTH DENTIST** Assesses the dental needs of a region, rather than of an individual patient. Also gives advice on preventing dental disease, and ensures that dental services meet public needs.



**COMMUNITY DENTIST** Works at health centers, mobile clinics, or care homes to offer dental care to children, people with special needs or physical disabilities, and the elderly.

**DENTIST** The requirements for becoming a licensed dentist vary by state. To specialize, you will need to undergo up to six years of further training in your chosen specialization.